

Pricing Recommendation Memo: Roamly Groups

To: Finance, Sales Leadership, Product Marketing

From: Samhita, Product Manager, Roamly Groups

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Subject: Commercial Model & Packaging Recommendation for Roamly Groups Launch

Executive Summary

Roamly Groups is ready for launch across our pilot markets (San Juan, Scottsdale, Lisbon). To beat Airbnb where their checkout breaks down and establish category leadership, we recommend a **Hybrid Transaction-Based Model**: \$0 upfront for the organizer, a standard 15% host take-rate, and a nominal 3%–5% coordination convenience fee paid by participants at mobile checkout.

This model removes all top-of-funnel friction for group organizers, directly monetizes high-AOV private buyouts, and creates an organic viral acquisition loop.

Strategic Alignment & Commercial Goal

- **Pricing Goal:** Enter a new market, prove it exists, and capture market share from Airbnb.
- **The Strategic Bet (M2 Trace):** Airbnb controls travel chronology by capturing lodging first, but fails at the activity checkout stage due to single-card liability and forced app onboarding. Our strategic wedge is becoming the default coordination engine for high-stakes centerpiece celebrations (bachelorettes, birthdays, milestone trips).
- **Commercial Rationale:** Adding SaaS subscriptions or organizer platform fees introduces friction, driving planners back to manual Venmo spreadsheets. Winning requires maximizing transaction velocity and calendar liquidity for our 12,000 vetted hosts.

The Pricing Model: Who Pays and What For

Value in Roamly Groups is discrete and event-driven. We exchange value through a **Hybrid Transaction-Based Model**:

1. **The Organizer (The Buyer) pays \$0 upfront:**

- *What they get:* 24-hour calendar hold, automated payment enforcement, and zero personal credit card liability.
 - *Mechanism:* A credit card pre-authorization holds peak inventory without a hard charge.
2. **The Participants (The Users/Payers) pay a 3%–5% split convenience fee:**
- *What they get:* Transparent, 15-second guest mobile checkout (Apple Pay/Google Pay) with zero app download or account creation required.
 - *Cost impact:* On a 150 *private winery or catamaran ticket*, an attendee pays ~6 in processing (\$156 total).
3. **The Host Community pays a 15% marketplace take-rate:**
- *What they get:* Guaranteed gross booking value on private buyouts, protected calendar liquidity, and elimination of group cancellations.

Packaging Structure & Tier Architecture

Packaging is structured **By Products & Features**, routing group volume away from low-margin public catalog listings into dedicated, high-AOV private inventory.

Tier	Target Audience & AOV	Core Inclusions	Fee Structure
Tier 1: Standard Catalog	Solo travelers & pairs	• Open public session inventory	15% Host Take-Rate
	(AOV: 35–60)	• Standard 1-card checkout	\$0 Traveler Fee

Tier 2: Roamly Groups Buyout	Milestone Organizers (6–12 guests)	• 24-Hour Calendar Hold Lock	15% Host Commission
(★ <i>Core Focus: 80% Volume</i>)	(AOV: 1,000–3,500)	• No-login 15s mobile web guest checkout	+ 4% Guest Split Fee
		• Real-time SMS/WhatsApp payment ledger	(\$0 Organizer Platform Fee)
		• Community-upvoted itinerary badges	
Tier 3: Concierge VIP	Luxury villas & corporate retreats	• 48-Hour calendar hold lock	18% Host Take-Rate
	(AOV: \$4,000+)	• Multi-vendor custom bundles (chef + boat)	+ \$99 Concierge Fee
		• Dedicated Roamly itinerary concierge	

Stakeholder Alignment: What Each Team Needs to Hear

For Finance: Unit Economics & Margin Expansion

- **Net Take-Rate Expansion:** Blending a 15% host take-rate with a 4% participant convenience fee yields an effective marketplace take-rate of **~18.5%–19%** per completed group reservation.
- **Zero Capital Float Risk:** Roamly acts strictly as the payment orchestrator. Inventory is released automatically if unpaid at hour 24, preventing platform exposure to bad debt or chargebacks.

- **High-AOV Focus:** Shifting transaction mix to private buyouts increases average booking value from ~\$120 (pairs) to \$1,800+ per cart.

For Sales & Business Development: Host Acquisition & Retention Leverage

- **Host Calendar Liquidity Protected:** The strict 24-hour cutoff paired with our organizer auto-cover backstop guarantees that hosts rarely hold dead calendar dates (<5% slot release rate).
- **Predictable Revenue:** Pitching 100% buyout occupancy gives sales massive leverage when locking exclusivity with top-tier operators across our 40 launch cities.

For Product Marketing: Clear Positioning & Frictionless Virality

- **No Positioning Conflict:** "Secure your event. Empower your crew. Let Roamly handle the rest." The \$0 organizer fee reinforces our promise of social relief and zero personal liability.
- **Built-in Viral Acquisition Loop:** Every organizer checkout link delivers an average of 6.8 new unique consumers into Roamly's web flow without paid acquisition spend.

Critical Research Validation & Contingency

- **Commissioned Method: Conjoint Analysis (Discrete Choice Modeling)** across 400 target milestone travelers.
- **The Single Assumption to Validate First:**
Assumption: Invited participants perceive a 3%–5% split fee as an acceptable convenience charge rather than an unfair checkout friction point.
- **How We Test It:** Present participants with realistic mobile checkout drawers varying fee presentations (3% line-item fee vs. 5% line-item fee vs. \$0 fee with higher base ticket price) to measure checkout completion drop-off.
- **The Fatal Risk & Contingency:** If cart abandonment exceeds 5% at the payment drawer due to fee sensitivity, we immediately pivot to an **all-inclusive host-absorbed model**, baking the fee entirely into the host's advertised private ticket price so participants see a flat, fee-free split.

Post-Review Adjustments: What Changed & Why

1. **Stripped Upfront Organizer Fees:** Removed an earlier concept of a \$19 organizer reservation fee. The organizer already bears the emotional tax of planning; charging them upfront penalizes the champion and creates top-of-funnel drop-off.
2. **Fractionalized the Convenience Fee:** Shifted monetization to the participant payment drawer. Paying an extra 5–8 on a \$150 ticket via Apple Pay is practically invisible to individual attendees, but aggregates to substantial platform margin.
3. **Hardened the Finance Safeguard:** Replaced open-ended hold windows with a strict 24-hour countdown backed by pre-authorization, resolving supply-side objections from hosts and Finance.